

AXTO Playbooks — AI eXecution & Tools Orchestration

Consulting & Advisory Kit

25 prompts to sell, deliver, and scale your consulting practice

25 PROMPTS	PDF FORMAT	4 AI COMPATIBLE	\$29 USD
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Business Skills

Works with: ChatGPT · Claude · Gemini · Llama

About This Playbook

25 prompts for independent consultants, fractional executives, and boutique advisory firms — covering business development, engagement delivery, strategic frameworks, and client communication. Each prompt is calibrated for senior stakeholders: concise, outcome-focused, zero fluff.

How to Use This Playbook

- 1 **Copy the prompt** — Select the full prompt text from the section that matches your goal.
- 2 **Fill in the brackets** — Replace all [PLACEHOLDER] text with your specific context, brand, or product.
- 3 **Paste & generate** — Paste into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or your preferred AI tool.
- 4 **Iterate** — Use the output as a starting point. Refine with follow-up prompts for best results.

Who It's For

Independent consultants, fractional executives, boutique advisory firm partners, and anyone selling and delivering strategic services to businesses.

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Business Development

Prompt #01 — Discovery Call Script

Run a first meeting that establishes authority and uncovers real problems.

You are a senior management consultant. Write a discovery call script for a first meeting with a prospective client.

Deliver:

1. 45-minute call arc with time-boxed sections
2. Situation questions to open
3. Problem and implication questions that build urgency
4. Need-payoff close and next-step ask

Placeholders: [PROSPECT TITLE] · [COMPANY TYPE] · [YOUR SPECIALTY]

Tip: Spend more time on implication questions than problem questions — that's where urgency actually gets built.

Prompt #02 — Consulting Proposal Template

Write a proposal that sells the outcome, not just the hours.

You are a consulting principal who has closed 8-figure engagements. Write a consulting proposal template covering problem, approach, and fees.

Deliver:

1. Problem statement in the client's own language
2. Approach/methodology section (3-5 phases)
3. Fee structure with options (fixed, retainer, milestone-based)
4. Timeline and next steps

Placeholders: [CLIENT NAME] · [PROBLEM STATEMENT] · [FEE STRUCTURE]

Tip: Open the proposal by restating their problem back to them precisely — it's the single biggest trust signal.

Prompt #03 — Diagnostic Assessment Framework

Structure a paid or unpaid diagnostic engagement that leads to a bigger contract.

You are a management consultant specializing in organizational diagnostics. Write a diagnostic assessment framework and deliverable outline for a new prospect.

Deliver:

1. Assessment scope and data-gathering plan
2. Interview and document review checklist
3. Deliverable structure (findings + recommendations)
4. Pricing/positioning as a paid first step

Placeholders: [CLIENT INDUSTRY] · [ASSESSMENT SCOPE] · [TIMELINE]

Tip: Price the diagnostic to cover your time, not to be a loss leader — a paid diagnostic filters for serious clients.

Prompt #04 — Capability Statement One-Pager

Summarize your firm's credibility in a single page for RFPs and introductions.

You are a B2B positioning specialist for professional services firms. Write a one-page capability statement for a consulting practice.

Deliver:

1. Firm overview (2-3 sentences)
2. Core service areas (bulleted)
3. Differentiators / why-us section
4. Representative results or client types (anonymized if needed)

Placeholders: [FIRM NAME] · [CORE SERVICES] · [KEY DIFFERENTIATOR]

Tip: Lead with the client outcome you're best known for, not your years of experience — outcomes get remembered.

Prompt #05 — Case Study Template

Turn a completed engagement into a case study that sells future work.

You are a B2B case study writer for consulting and advisory firms. Write a case study using the situation-insight-action-result structure.

Deliver:

1. Situation: client context and starting problem
2. Insight: the key diagnosis that changed the approach
3. Action: what was actually done (concise, specific)
4. Result: quantified outcome + client quote placeholder

Placeholders: [CLIENT TYPE/INDUSTRY] · [STARTING METRIC] · [RESULTING METRIC]

Tip: A quantified result beats a glowing testimonial every time — always try to get one real number.

Prompt #06 — Retainer Offer Letter

Convert a project-based client into an ongoing retainer relationship.

You are a consulting business development advisor. Write a retainer offer letter for transitioning a project client to ongoing advisory support.

Deliver:

1. Recap of value delivered on the completed project
2. Retainer scope and monthly deliverables
3. Pricing and commitment terms
4. Clear next step to convert

Placeholders: [CLIENT NAME] · [COMPLETED PROJECT SUMMARY] · [RETAINER SCOPE]

Tip: Anchor the retainer price against the cost of solving the next problem from scratch, not against your hourly rate.

Section 2 of 4 Delivery

Prompt #07 — Project Kick-Off Workshop Agenda

Start every engagement with clear alignment on goals, roles, and cadence.

You are a consulting engagement manager. Write a kick-off workshop agenda for a new consulting engagement.

Deliver:

1. Objectives and success criteria alignment segment
2. Stakeholder roles and RACI review
3. Timeline and milestone walkthrough
4. Communication cadence and escalation path

Placeholders: [ENGAGEMENT NAME] · [KEY STAKEHOLDERS] · [SUCCESS CRITERIA]

Tip: Get written agreement on success criteria in the kick-off — vague goals are the top cause of scope disputes later.

Prompt #08 — Current State Assessment Report

Document what's actually happening before recommending what should change.

You are a business analyst producing client-facing assessment reports. Write a current state assessment report structure with findings summary.

Deliver:

1. Executive summary of key findings
2. Process/data walkthrough by area
3. Strengths and gaps identified
4. Transition into next-phase recommendations

Placeholders: [ASSESSMENT AREA] · [KEY FINDINGS] · [DATA SOURCES USED]

Tip: Separate 'what we observed' from 'what we recommend' into distinct sections — mixing them undermines credibility.

Prompt #09 — Gap Analysis Narrative

Explain the distance between current and target state in language executives act on.

You are a strategy consultant specializing in gap analysis. Write a gap analysis narrative comparing current state to target state.

Deliver:

1. Current state summary
2. Target state definition

3. Prioritized list of gaps with business impact
4. Quick-win vs. structural-change categorization

Placeholders: [CURRENT STATE] · [TARGET STATE] · [TOP 3 GAPS]

Tip: Rank gaps by business impact, not by ease of fixing — executives fund impact, not convenience.

Prompt #10 — Recommendations Report Structure

Deliver recommendations that get approved, not shelved.

You are a management consultant known for high-adoption recommendation reports. Write a recommendations report structure with an executive brief and supporting detail.

Deliver:

1. One-page executive brief (decision-ready)
2. Detailed recommendation sections with rationale
3. Cost/effort/impact scoring per recommendation
4. Implementation sequencing

Placeholders: [TOP RECOMMENDATIONS] · [ESTIMATED COST/EFFORT] · [EXPECTED IMPACT]

Tip: Put the ask on page one. Executives decide from the executive brief; the appendix is for their team, not them.

Prompt #11 — Implementation Roadmap

Turn approved recommendations into a sequenced, ownable plan.

You are a program management consultant. Write an implementation roadmap with phases, owners, and milestones.

Deliver:

1. Phase breakdown (e.g., 30/60/90-day)
2. Owner assignment per workstream
3. Milestone and dependency mapping
4. Risk and mitigation notes

Placeholders: [APPROVED RECOMMENDATIONS] · [TIMELINE] · [KEY OWNERS]

Tip: Assign a named owner to every workstream before the roadmap is finalized — unowned items never ship.

Prompt #12 — Stakeholder Alignment Presentation

Get buy-in from stakeholders who weren't in the room for the analysis.

You are a change management consultant. Write a stakeholder alignment presentation outline for socializing recommendations.

Deliver:

1. Context-setting opener for people new to the project
2. Findings summary in plain language
3. 'What this means for you' section per stakeholder group
4. Q&A; and objection-handling notes

Placeholders: [STAKEHOLDER GROUPS] · [KEY MESSAGE] · [ANTICIPATED OBJECTIONS]

Tip: Prepare a specific 'what this means for you' slide per stakeholder group — generic summaries lose the room.

Prompt #13 — Progress Review Meeting Template

Run recurring status meetings that build confidence instead of anxiety.

You are a consulting engagement manager. Write a progress review meeting template for a multi-month engagement.

Deliver:

1. Status-against-plan summary format
2. Wins, risks, and decisions-needed sections
3. Next-period focus and asks of the client

Placeholders: [ENGAGEMENT PHASE] · [KEY METRICS] · [DECISIONS NEEDED]

Tip: Always end with 'decisions needed from you' — status updates without a client ask feel passive.

Prompt #14 — Final Engagement Summary + Expansion Pitch

Close an engagement while opening the door to the next one.

You are a consulting partner focused on account growth. Write a final engagement summary that also pitches a natural next-phase expansion.

Deliver:

1. Results summary with quantified impact
2. Lessons learned / what's next section
3. Specific expansion opportunity identified during the engagement
4. Clear next step to continue the relationship

Placeholders: [RESULTS ACHIEVED] · [EXPANSION OPPORTUNITY] · [NEXT STEP]

Tip: Identify the expansion opportunity during delivery, not after — it should feel like a natural continuation, not a new sales pitch.

Section 3 of 4 Frameworks & Deliverables

Prompt #15 — SWOT Analysis Narrative

Turn a SWOT grid into a narrative executives actually read.

You are a strategy consultant. Write a SWOT analysis narrative (not just a grid) for a client situation.

Deliver:

1. Strengths and weaknesses framed against the target market
2. Opportunities and threats framed against industry trends
3. So-what synthesis connecting the four quadrants to a recommendation

Placeholders: [COMPANY/BU NAME] · [MARKET CONTEXT] · [KEY STRATEGIC QUESTION]

Tip: Always end a SWOT with a synthesis paragraph — the grid alone never tells the client what to do.

Prompt #16 — Market Opportunity Sizing Brief

Size a market opportunity credibly, without overstating it.

You are a market strategy analyst. Write a market opportunity sizing brief using a top-down and bottom-up approach.

Deliver:

1. Top-down TAM estimate with sourcing
2. Bottom-up estimate based on target segment math
3. Reconciliation of the two figures
4. Key assumptions and sensitivity notes

Placeholders: [MARKET/SEGMENT] · [TAM SOURCE] · [KEY ASSUMPTIONS]

Tip: Always show both top-down and bottom-up numbers — a single estimate invites (justified) skepticism.

Prompt #17 — Competitive Landscape Summary

Map competitors in a way that clarifies strategy, not just lists names.

You are a competitive intelligence analyst. Write a competitive landscape summary with strategic positioning implications.

Deliver:

1. Competitor set definition and selection rationale
2. Positioning map (2 key axes)
3. White-space identification
4. Strategic implications for the client

Placeholders: [COMPETITOR SET] · [POSITIONING AXES] · [IDENTIFIED WHITE SPACE]

Tip: Pick positioning axes that matter to the buyer, not axes that are easy to research — relevance beats data availability.

Prompt #18 — Operating Model Assessment

Evaluate whether an org's operating model actually supports its strategy.

You are an organizational design consultant. Write an operating model assessment covering structure, process, and governance fit.

Deliver:

1. Current operating model description
2. Fit assessment against stated strategy
3. Misalignments identified with business impact
4. Recommended model adjustments

Placeholders: [CURRENT MODEL] · [STATED STRATEGY] · [KEY MISALIGNMENTS]

Tip: Assess structure, process, AND governance separately — most operating model failures are a governance gap, not a structure gap.

Prompt #19 — Change Readiness Evaluation

Assess whether an organization is actually ready for the change being proposed.

You are a change management consultant. Write a change readiness evaluation with a scoring framework.

Deliver:

1. Readiness dimensions (leadership sponsorship, culture, capacity, history of change)
2. Scoring approach per dimension
3. Risk flags and mitigation recommendations

Placeholders: [PROPOSED CHANGE] · [ORGANIZATION CONTEXT] · [KEY RISK AREAS]

Tip: Leadership sponsorship strength predicts change success better than any other single factor — weight it heavily.

Prompt #20 — ROI Business Case Builder

Build a credible ROI case that survives finance's scrutiny.

You are a business case and ROI modeling specialist. Write a business case structure with an ROI model for a proposed initiative.

Deliver:

1. Cost breakdown (one-time + ongoing)
2. Benefit quantification with sourcing/assumptions
3. Payback period and ROI calculation
4. Sensitivity scenarios (conservative/base/optimistic)

Placeholders: [INITIATIVE] · [COST ESTIMATE] · [BENEFIT DRIVERS]

Tip: Always present a conservative scenario alongside the base case — finance trusts the number more when you show the downside.

Section 4 of 4

Client Communication

Prompt #21 — Weekly Status Update

Keep clients informed without burying them in detail.

You are a consulting engagement manager. Write a weekly status update template for an active client engagement.

Deliver:

1. This week's progress (3-5 bullets)
2. Next week's focus
3. Risks or blockers
4. Asks of the client, if any

Placeholders: [ENGAGEMENT NAME] · [THIS WEEK'S PROGRESS] · [NEXT WEEK'S FOCUS]

Tip: Keep it under one page — a status update that takes 5 minutes to read gets read; one that takes 15 gets skimmed.

Prompt #22 — Scope Expansion Request

Request additional scope/budget without souring the relationship.

You are an engagement manager handling scope changes. Write a scope expansion request explaining why additional work is needed.

Deliver:

1. Explanation of what was discovered that wasn't in original scope
2. Specific additional scope and cost
3. Impact if the expansion isn't approved
4. Options (full scope vs. reduced alternative)

Placeholders: [NEW SCOPE ITEM] · [ADDITIONAL COST] · [REASON FOR CHANGE]

Tip: Always offer a reduced-scope alternative alongside the full ask — it signals partnership, not padding.

Prompt #23 — Difficult Feedback Delivery Script

Deliver hard feedback to a client stakeholder without damaging the relationship.

You are a senior consultant experienced in difficult client conversations. Write a script for delivering difficult feedback to a client stakeholder.

Deliver:

1. Opening that establishes shared goals before the critique
2. Specific, evidence-based feedback (not generalized)
3. Constructive path forward

4. Closing that reaffirms the partnership

Placeholders: [FEEDBACK TOPIC] · [SPECIFIC EVIDENCE] · [STAKEHOLDER ROLE]

Tip: Lead with the shared goal, not the problem — 'we both want X, and here's what's getting in the way' lands far better than a direct critique.

Prompt #24 — Engagement Extension Pitch

Extend an engagement that's ending before it's fully realized value.

You are a consulting account manager. Write an engagement extension pitch for a client near the end of a contract.

Deliver:

1. Value delivered so far, quantified
2. Specific remaining work that justifies extension
3. Extension terms and pricing
4. Risk of stopping now vs. continuing

Placeholders: [VALUE DELIVERED] · [REMAINING WORK] · [EXTENSION TERMS]

Tip: Quantify the risk of stopping, not just the benefit of continuing — loss aversion is a stronger motivator than upside.

Prompt #25 — Referral Request to Satisfied Client

Ask a happy client for a referral without it feeling transactional.

You are a business development advisor for professional services. Write a referral request message to a satisfied client.

Deliver:

1. Specific reference to the value delivered
2. Clear, low-friction referral ask
3. Optional: description of ideal referral profile

Placeholders: [CLIENT NAME] · [VALUE DELIVERED] · [IDEAL REFERRAL PROFILE]

Tip: Describe your ideal next client specifically — vague 'know anyone who needs help?' asks rarely convert.
